“Life Satisfaction and Social Network Addiction among Generation Z”

➢ Summary of the Project Work

- This study examined the relationship between **Social Network Addiction (SNA)** and **Life Satisfaction** among **100 Gen Z participants (ages 15–29)** using a quantitative correlational design .
- Data were collected using two standardized tools:
  Social Network Addiction Scale (SNAS) and **Life Satisfaction Scale (Neugarten et al., 1968)** .
- SNAS measured three dimensions: **Impulsivity, Virtual Freedom, and Negative Outcomes**, while Life Satisfaction measured overall subjective well-being .
- Statistical analysis was conducted using **SPSS**, including descriptive statistics, normality tests, and **Spearman’s rho correlation** due to non-normal data distribution .
- Results showed that:
  - **Virtual Freedom positively influenced Life Satisfaction**
  - **Negative Outcomes reduced Life Satisfaction**
  - **Impulsivity acted as an indirect risk factor** rather than a direct predictor .

➢ Expected Questions by External Examiner (Including Out-of-the-Box)

📌 Project-Based Questions

1. Why did you choose this topic?
2. What is Social Network Addiction?
3. Why did you focus only on Gen Z?
4. Why did you use SNAS and LS scales?
5. Why was Spearman’s correlation used instead of Pearson’s?
6. What are the main findings of your study?
7. What are the practical implications of your results?
8. What are the limitations of your study?
9. How can this research help society?

📌 Methodology-Based Questions

10. Why did you use convenience and snowball sampling?
11. Why is your study correlational and not experimental?
12. How did you ensure ethical standards?

13. What is non-probability sampling?
14. Why is generalization limited in your study?

📌 **Out-of-the-Box Questions**

15. If you repeated this study after 5 years, what might change?
16. How would results differ for rural youth?
17. Can social media ever be completely beneficial?
18. How would AI and future platforms affect life satisfaction?
19. If you were a policymaker, what would you recommend?
20. Can addiction ever improve productivity?

➢ **Explaining the Correlation Table (For Examiner Questions)**

If the examiner asks: *"Explain your correlation results"*, answer like this:

- We used **Spearman's rho** because most variables were not normally distributed, as shown in the normality tests .
- **Impulsivity and Life Satisfaction** showed a weak, non-significant negative relationship ($r = -.170$, $p = .091$), meaning impulsivity alone does not strongly affect happiness.
- **Virtual Freedom and Life Satisfaction** had a significant positive correlation ($r = .262$, $p = .031$), showing that online autonomy improves well-being.
- **Negative Outcomes and Life Satisfaction** had a significant negative correlation ($r = -.215$, $p = .031$), indicating harmful effects reduce happiness.
- **Impulsivity and Negative Outcomes** showed a strong positive correlation ($r = .407$, $p < .001$), proving impulsivity increases negative consequences.

➢ **Expected Questions with Sample Answers (Viva Ready)**

Q1. Why did you choose this topic?

Answer:
Social media is highly influential among Gen Z, and its psychological effects are increasing. I wanted to understand how addiction affects life satisfaction.

Q2. What is Social Network Addiction?

Answer:
It refers to compulsive, uncontrollable use of social networking sites that interferes with daily life, academic work, and emotional health.

Q3. Why Spearman's correlation?

Answer:
Because most variables were not normally distributed, so Spearman's rho was more appropriate than Pearson's.

Q4. What was your major finding?

Answer:
Negative Outcomes reduce life satisfaction, while Virtual Freedom improves it. Impulsivity mainly works indirectly.

Q5. What is Virtual Freedom?

Answer:
It is the sense of autonomy and self-expression users feel in online environments.

Q6. Why is impulsivity important?

Answer:
Impulsivity increases negative outcomes, which later reduce life satisfaction, making it an indirect risk factor.

Q7. What are the limitations?

Answer:
Small sample size, self-report bias, limited geography, and cross-sectional design.

Q8. Can you prove causation?

Answer:
No. Since it is a correlational study, only relationships can be identified, not cause-effect.

Q9. How is this useful practically?

Answer:
It helps counsellors, educators, and parents promote healthy digital habits and prevent addiction.

Q10. If you improve this study, what will you do?

Answer:
I would increase sample size, include Millennials, add qualitative interviews, and conduct longitudinal research.

✅ Final Viva Tip for You

When answering:

👉 Always follow this structure:

Definition → Method → Result → Implication

Example:

"We used Spearman's correlation because data was non-normal. We found that Negative Outcomes reduce life satisfaction. This shows harmful usage lowers well-being."

Here is a **clear, confident, and exam-oriented explanation** of the **main purpose of your project** and **why you chose it**.
You can use this directly in your viva or presentation.

- **Main Purpose of the Project and Its Importance**

The main purpose of this project is to **understand how social network addiction affects life satisfaction among Generation Z**. In today's digital age, social media has become an essential part of young people's daily lives for communication, learning, and entertainment. However, excessive and uncontrolled use may lead to addiction-like behaviors, emotional stress, and reduced well-being. Therefore, this study aims to examine whether and how such usage patterns influence overall happiness and satisfaction with life.

Specifically, the project seeks to analyze the relationship between **three key dimensions of social network addiction—Impulsivity, Virtual Freedom, and Negative Outcomes—and Life Satisfaction**. By studying these components, the research helps identify which aspects of social media use are beneficial and which are harmful. This enables a deeper understanding of the psychological mechanisms linking digital behavior to well-being.

The project was undertaken because **Generation Z is the most digitally active generation**, having grown up with smartphones and social networking platforms. Despite their high engagement, limited research has focused on how this continuous online presence affects their mental health and quality of life, especially in the local context. This created a research gap that the present study aimed to address.

Another important reason for choosing this topic is its **practical relevance**. Rising cases of stress, anxiety, and digital dependency among youth have become major social concerns. By identifying patterns of problematic use and their impact on life satisfaction, the study provides useful insights for educators, parents, counselors, and policymakers to promote healthy digital habits and emotional well-being.

Overall, the project was conducted to **balance the positive and negative aspects of social media use**, to encourage responsible online behavior, and to contribute to the growing field of digital well-being research. It helps in understanding how young people can enjoy the benefits of social media while minimizing its harmful effects on their mental health and life satisfaction.